

Upload Your Video: Step by Step

Video: Why Is a Costco Hot Dog Only \$1.50? · **Channel:** The Business Stick (@TheBusinessStickHQ)

Everything you need to copy is in a **dashed blue box** in this PDF. Highlight it, copy (Ctrl+C), paste (Ctrl+V).

Have these 3 files ready on your computer:

-  **Video:** `costco-hot-dog-final.mp4` (the one you joined, about 600 MB)
-  **Thumbnail:** `warehouse-still150-v2.jpg`
-  **Captions:** `costco-hot-dog-english.srt` (new, sent with this PDF)

Step 1: Start the upload

1. ☐ Go to **studio.youtube.com** on your computer.
2. ☐ Click **Create** (top right) → **Upload videos**.
3. ☐ Click **Select files**, pick `costco-hot-dog-final.mp4`, click **Open**.
4. ☐ It uploads in the background. Keep the page open and fill in the rest while it goes.

Step 2: Details page

☐ Title (copy exactly)

Why Is a Costco Hot Dog Only \$1.50?

☐ Description (copy the whole box)

Why: the first two lines show in search results, the chapters make clickable sections, the sources build trust, and the 3 hashtags at the bottom show up as blue links above your title.

Why is a Costco hot dog still \$1.50 after 40 years? A top Costco executive once pushed to raise the price – and co-founder Jim Sinegal's answer became business legend: "If you raise the price of the hot dog, I will kill you."

Here's the real reason the price never moves (it was never about the hot dog).

👉 Subscribe for more business stories told simply with stick figures:
https://www.youtube.com/@TheBusinessStickHQ?sub_confirmation=1

Chapters

0:00 The \$1.50 paradox
0:52 A price frozen in time
1:47 "Figure it out"
3:07 Rebuilding the hot dog
4:33 The real product
5:47 The \$400 million chicken
7:05 What the hot dog really costs
7:42 Next: New Coke

Sources

- Costco Wholesale Corp., Form 10-K for fiscal year 2025: total revenue \$275.2B, membership fees \$5.32B, operating income ~\$10.4B, renewal rate 92.3% (U.S. & Canada). SEC EDGAR.
- Costco food court sales of 245.1 million hot dog and soda combos in fiscal 2025 – reported by Mashed, Chowhound and AOL from Costco's annual report.
- Original 1985 combo (quarter-pound hot dog + 12 oz can of soda) vs. today (10% bigger hot dog + 20 oz fountain soda with refills) – KOMO News, Chowhound.
- Craig Jelinek's account of Jim Sinegal's "Figure it out" response (told to 425 Business, 2018; Jelinek was CEO 2012–2023) – Business Insider, Today, Fox Business.
- Costco's switch from Hebrew National to Kirkland Signature hot dogs (2009) and its own hot dog plants in Tracy, California, and Morris, Illinois (second plant from 2018) – Food Republic, The Takeout, Chowhound.
- Costco's switch from Coca-Cola to Pepsi (2013, to cut costs and protect the \$1.50 price) and back to Coca-Cola (announced by CEO Ron Vachris Jan. 23, 2025; rolled out summer 2025) – ABC News affiliates, Progressive Grocer, Reader's Digest.
- Jim Sinegal's "heroin" comparison on raising prices – as recounted by Eric Ries; Yahoo Finance.
- Costco's 14% / 15% markup cap – widely reported; Yahoo Finance.
- Rotisserie chicken at \$4.99 since 2009, Richard Galanti on being "willing to eat... \$30 to \$40 million a year in gross margin" (Seattle Times, 2015), and the \$400–450 million Nebraska poultry complex in Fremont (opened Sept. 2019, built for up to 2 million chickens/week) – KSL / CNN, WATTAgnNet, Meatingplace, Supermarket News.
- New Coke launched April 1985 after winning blind taste tests; withdrawn within ~3 months (bridge teaser – full sourcing in the New Coke video).
- 2026 combo update (from April 2026) adding a 16.9 oz Kirkland Signature bottled-water option at the same \$1.50 – Axios (May 2026), Boing Boing, Cheapism.
- 157.4 million rotisserie chickens sold in fiscal 2025, per Costco's annual shareholder report – Tasting Table, AOL.
- Inflation adjustment: \$1.50 in 1985 ≈ \$4.66 in 2026 (BLS CPI 107.6 → ~334) – U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics CPI data.

This video is for entertainment and education. It is not sponsored by or affiliated with Costco.

#Costco #BusinessStories #HotDog

☐ Thumbnail

Click **Upload thumbnail** → pick `warehouse-still150-v2.jpg` . If you see **Test & compare**, you can add the other warehouse version too and let YouTube pick the winner.

☐ Playlist

Click **Select** → **Create playlist** → name it `Business Stories` → Public → **Create** → tick it → **Done**. Why: playlists keep viewers watching your next video, which YouTube rewards.

☐ Audience

Choose **"No, it's not made for kids."** (If you pick "kids", comments and many features are turned off.)

☐ Click "Show more" and set these

- **Altered content: No** (stick-figure cartoons don't look like real people or real events).
- **Paid promotion:** leave unticked (nobody paid you).
- **Tags:** paste this box:

costco hot dog, costco \$1.50 hot dog, costco hot dog price, why costco hot dog is 1.50, costco business strategy, costco membership, costco rotisserie chicken, jim sinegal, craig jelinek, business stories, loss leader, costco food court, costco hot dog combo, why costco hot dog is cheap, the business stick

- **Language and captions certification:** Video language = **English**. Caption certification = **None**.
- **Recording date / location:** skip.
- **License:** Standard YouTube License. Leave **Allow embedding** and **Publish to subscriptions feed** ticked.
- **Shorts remixing:** Allow video and audio remixing (free exposure when people remix you).
- **Category:** Education.
- **Comments:** On. Sort by **Top**.
- **Show how many viewers like this video:** leave ticked.

☐ Click **Next**.

Step 3: Video elements page

☐ Add subtitles (captions)

1. Click **Add** next to Subtitles. If it asks for a language, choose **English**.
2. Click **Upload file** → choose **With timing** → **Continue** → pick `costco-hot-dog-english.srt`.
3. Check the first few lines look right, then click **Done**.

Why: correct captions (names like Sinegal and Jelinek spelled right) help people watching on mute, and YouTube reads them to understand what your video is about, which helps search.

☐ End screen

Click **Add** → pick the template with **1 video + subscribe** → set the video to **Best for viewer** → drag the video box to the side the mascot points at → **Save**.

☐ Cards

Skip for now.

☐ Click **Next**.

Step 4: Checks

1. ☐ Wait for "**No issues found**" (copyright check takes a few minutes).
2. ☐ Click **Next**.

Step 5: Visibility (when it goes live)

1. ☐ Choose **Schedule** and pick a time when **you can be online for the first hour**. A weekday or weekend around **2–5 PM your time** is a good default.
2. ☐ Leave **Set as Premiere** off.
3. ☐ Click **Schedule** (or choose **Public** → **Publish** to post right now).

Wait until the upload says "**Processing HD**" is finished before it goes public, so the first viewers see it sharp. Scheduling 1–2 hours ahead takes care of this.

Step 6: The first hour after it's live

☐ Post and pin a comment

Under your video, post this comment, then click  on it → **Pin**:

If Costco raised the hot dog to \$2, would you still buy it? 🌭👉

(Sources for everything in this video are in the description.)

Why: a simple question gets people commenting, and comments tell YouTube the video is worth showing to more people.

- ☐ **Reply to every comment** in the first day, and tap the ❤️ on them. Each reply counts as activity on the video.
- ☐ **Feature it on your channel**: Studio → **Customization** → **Layout** → **Featured video for returning subscribers / Channel trailer for people who haven't subscribed** → pick this video → **Publish**.
- ☐ **Share the link** with friends or family who'd actually enjoy it (people who watch to the end help most; don't ask people to just click and leave).

Step 7: A few hours later: the first clip

1. ☐ Post clip1-i-will-kill-you.mp4 on **YouTube Shorts, TikTok and Instagram Reels** with the Day 0 caption from your Posting Plan.
2. ☐ On YouTube Shorts, set **Related video** to this full Costco video. This puts a clickable link on the Short.
3. ☐ Make sure your TikTok and Instagram bios link to your YouTube channel.

Step 8: Check how it's doing

- ☐ **After 48 hours and after 7 days**: open the video in Studio → **Analytics**.
- **Impressions click-through rate**: 4–10% is healthy for a new channel.
- **Audience retention**: look at how many people are still watching at **0:30**. Send me a screenshot and I'll tell you what it means.

Don'ts

- ✗ Don't change the title or thumbnail in the first 2–3 days. Give it time first.
- ✗ Don't buy views, subscribers or use "sub for sub" groups. It hurts how YouTube recommends you.
- ✗ Don't add more hashtags. More than 15 and YouTube ignores all of them; 3 is ideal.

Ads: they unlock after YouTube accepts you into the Partner Program (1,000 subscribers + 4,000 watch hours, or 10M Shorts views). Then open the video's **Earn** tab and set mid-roll ads to automatic. The video is over 8 minutes, so it's ready for them.

If something on your screen looks different, YouTube may have moved a button. Look for a word close to the one here.